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Trump's limits on mail-in votes can proceed

Justices allow for start of process but final legality of plan remains unclear

By Abbie VanSickle
and Ann E. Marimow
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A divided Supreme Court on Monday allowed the Trump administration to move forward with plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterm elections. In an emergency order, the justices said President Trump could proceed with implementing an executive order he had signed, which directed the US Postal Service to help decide which voters should receive

mail-in ballots. Under the executive order, the Department of Homeland Security will also create lists of citizens that the administration believes could be used to monitor voter rolls for noncitizens. The decision means the administration can move ahead with planning for restricting the use of mail ballots even as a lower court continues to weigh the legality of Trump's executive order. But with a little more than two months until Election Day — and considerably less

time before early voting begins in many states — it remains unclear whether the White House's rules will be in effect for a midterm election in which control of both chambers is at stake. Additional legal action is a near certainty with the plan's fate not yet final. A separate injunction by the same lower court complicates matters. That court action prevents the Postal Service from implementing some parts of the executive order. That case could also soon be headed to the justices. Monday's order from the Supreme Court was unsigned, as is typical in such emergency rulings. The

majority wrote that it agreed with the government's argument that it should be able to move forward with its plans, finding that the Trump administration was "likely to suffer irreparable harm" unless the justices lifted a freeze that had been imposed by lower courts. The three liberal justices dissented, with Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson warning that the majority "needlessly injects chaos and uncertainty into the upcoming midterm elections." The majority said the states that challenged the president's order could not demonstrate that they

VOTING, Page A4

In a first, biotech jobs fall in Mass.

Signs, however point toward a comeback, heartening sector

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

The number of people working in Massachusetts' renowned biotech sector fell last year, the first time that's happened since at least 2002, according to a new report. The state's biopharma workforce shrank by about 3,600 employees in 2025, to a total of 113,503, as industry headwinds and uncertainty about federal funding for scientific research battered the sector, according to the annual "industry snapshot" by the Massachusetts Biotechnology Council trade group. Compared to 2024, the workforce declined by 3.1 percent.

3.1%
decline in biotech jobs, a loss of 3,600 workers.

Many of the lab buildings in Greater Boston that everyone thought would be filled with scientists when venture capital flowed freely early in the pandemic now stand empty, a symbol of what former Federal Reserve chairman Alan Greenspan once dubbed irrational exuberance. But before you bet against landing a biotech job in Massachusetts, take note: the 2025 employment total is almost certainly already out of date, said Ben Bradford, head of external affairs for MassBio. That's good news for Massachusetts, where biotech pumped roughly \$42 billion into the state's economy in 2024, according to the group's most recent available estimate. Workforce numbers typically lag behind a re-

JOBS, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Orange Line is still running south of the Back Bay Station. It won't be, however, from Sept. 10 to 14.

For T riders once more: It's off the beaten/soldered/replaced track

With Red, Green, then Orange lines down, another season of discontent looms

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

In the relative quiet of July, once the World Cup ended and the tall ships sailed away, the MBTA embarked on a slate of improvement projects that closed part of the Red Line, then the Green, and now the Orange. The parade of shutdowns has disrupted untold daily routines and forced T riders to strategize, frequently and frustratingly, about how to navigate Greater Boston with one train line inoperable almost all the time. Hannah Kirby last week planned to walk the two miles to her job as a clinical researcher during the ongoing Orange Line

stoppage. Leonardo Dantas decided he would rather work from his Melrose home than fight his way downtown. And Sophia Kotelly realized she would have to find another way to her boyfriend's apartment at Assembly Square. "I like to assume they're doing really great work down there during the shutdowns," added Jonathan Padrazo, an Orange Line rider from Malden whose daily travel time to his Back Bay job has doubled during the closure. "But it's difficult for me no matter which way you put it." Faced with an ever-mounting backlog of repairs and construction projects, the T under general manager Phil Eng is now regu-

larly shutting subway lines for extended periods instead of limiting work to nights and weekends when it is less disruptive to the traveling public. Agency leaders say the prolonged closures allow the T to catch up on years of deferred maintenance, faster and at less cost. "We're doing this work instead of kicking the can down the road," chief operating officer Ryan Coholan said. The problem for riders is obvious: Disruptions have seemingly sprouted everywhere, putting strap-hangers through a cascade of service suspensions that began last month and will continue through the fall.

SHUTDOWNS, Page A7

Healey's focus turns to public safety record

She says it's not campaign issue; GOP rivals disagree

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey drilled home a message when she signed a major immigration bill this month: The new law banning federal agents from making warrantless arrests in state courthouses was about "public safety." The law's focus, she emphasized, is "protecting public safety." "The law I'm signing today," she added, if only to underline the point, "is a public safety law." Healey, in turn, also gave herself a plank to add to her campaign platform. The first-term Democrat and her supporters have repeatedly tried to firm up her public safety credentials and guard her right flank against attacks concerning crime by two Republicans vying to challenge her in November. In recent months, Healey twice pressed to seat a former prosecutor on the state's Parole Board, de-

PUBLIC SAFETY, Page A7

Prosecution witness rejects Clancy claim

Testifies that her goal was to kill herself

By Shelley Murphy,
Travis Andersen,
and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — A forensic psychologist who evaluated Lindsay Clancy for prosecutors testified Monday that he rejects her claim she killed her three children while following the commands of a male voice in her head during a postpartum psychotic episode. Kirk Heilbrun offered a different motive that supports the prosecution's theo-



GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

A psychologist said Lindsay Clancy had "intrusive thoughts."

ry of the murder case against Clancy. He told jurors he concluded that Clancy had been having "intrusive thoughts" about killing herself for months and decided to commit suicide in early 2023 and take her children with her because "she was convinced that they would suffer without her." He suggested Clancy's claim about the voice was contrived, saying it was "very unusual" because she never heard the "command hallucination" before she strangled 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan in the basement

CLANCY, Page A10

A body found in the woods is believed to be a woman who is a suspect in the death of her husband, a veteran Worcester police officer. **B1.**

The Trump administration is preparing to revoke the business and tourism visas of up to 200,000 foreigners who are seeking asylum in what would be the largest single mass revocation of visas in US history. **A4.**

The Trump administration called it an economic apocalypse for Iran but it did not reveal many details of its plan to turn the fighting there into an economic battle. **A3.**

Massachusetts businesses and consumers could pay a price for President Trump's 50 percent tariffs on Canadian goods, Larry Edelman writes. **D1.**



Identical twin suns

Tuesday: Lots of sun.
High 78-83, low 63-68.

Wednesday: Lots of sun.
High 78-83, low 63-68.

Sunrise: 6:02. Sunset: 7:30.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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